

DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY



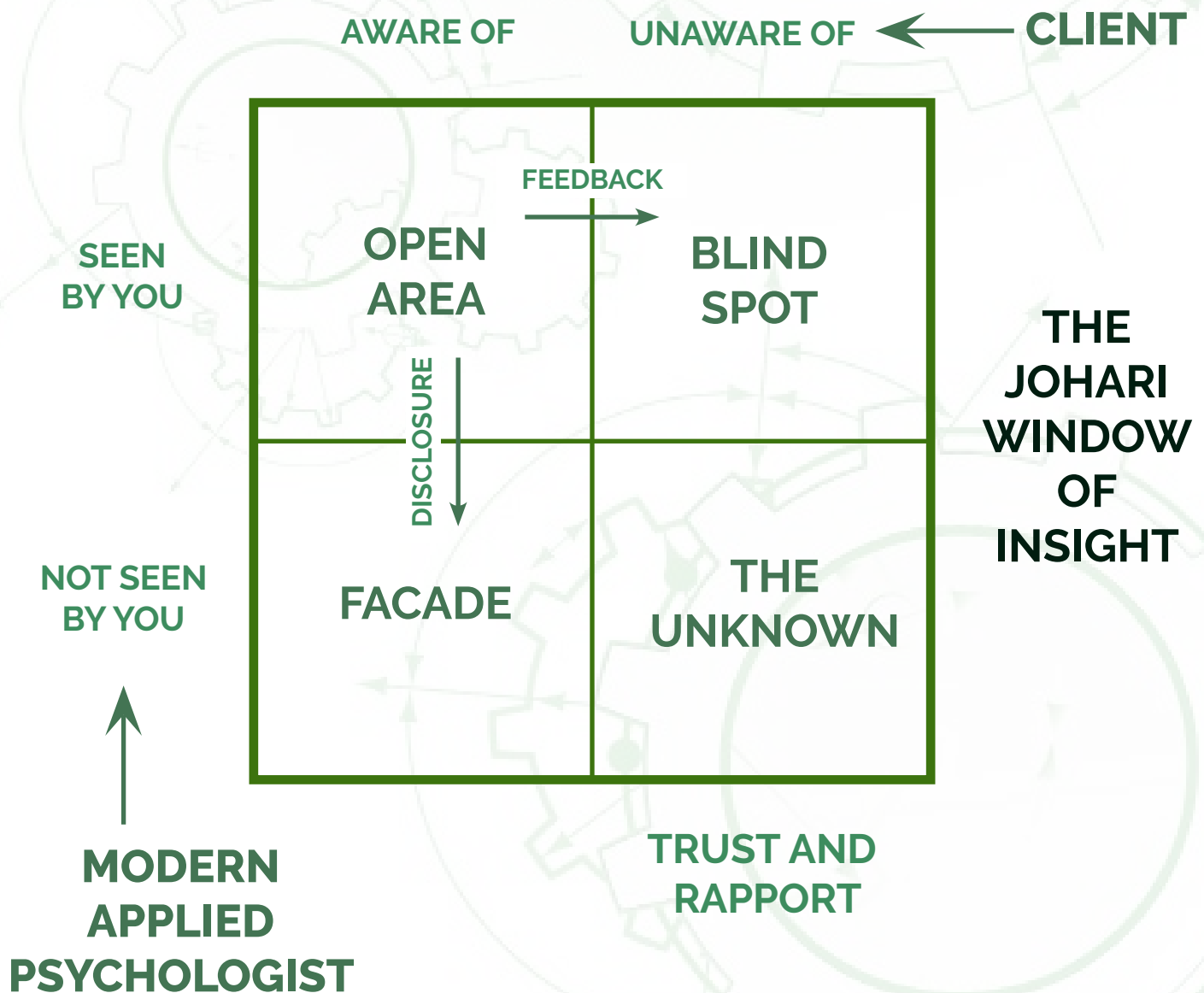
**THE JOHARI WINDOW
OF PERSONAL INSIGHT**

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The name Johari Window may sound like an overly complicated psychological process, but rest assured that it isn't. Back in 1955, you might be surprised to learn that Joseph Luft and Harrington (Harry) Ingham created the name 'Johari' for their model by merely combining their first names.

The Johari Window was first used in 1955 and has since become a widely used model for understanding and training in a variety of self-awareness centred activities such as personal development, communications, interpersonal relationships, group dynamics, team development and even inter-group relationships.

The Johari Window model provides us with a useful format for representing our personal experience of life (and our degree of self-awareness) from four alternative perspectives. This model can serve us as an excellent self-reflection tool for comparing the perception we have of ourselves to the impression that other people might have of us - within itself, this can become a guide map for making personal developmental improvements.



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It is, however, important to stress here that there's a huge difference between empathically relating to someone and parallel processing. Parallel processing is when a professional, be they a coach, therapist or practitioner parallels a client's issues by relating their problems to their own experience.

The Johari window model helps professionals personally improve in:

- Self-Awareness
- Personal Development
- Improving Communications
- Interpersonal Relationships
- Group Dynamics

THE FOUR JOHARI QUADRANTS

Quadrant 1. The 'Open Area' Johari quadrant, also referred to as the 'area of free Activity', related to the public persona we are aware we put on, and therefore the parts of ourselves we know other people know of us. Examples of this may include our various bad habits, good habits, personality traits, communication styles, professional competences or even our attitude.

Having a focus on strengthening our 'Open Area' quadrant helps us become more committed to living a transparent, authentic and congruent life. This healthy approach towards life means we show more of ourselves to others, which in turn makes us more relatable and trustworthy. Expansion of the 'Public' minimises the impact of the distortions external prejudices impose upon us, as it encourages and empowers us to be braver in taking opportunities to engage in dialectic when necessary.

The scale of a person's 'Open Area' quadrant is the ever-evolving outcome of healthy working relationships in a personal, social or professional contexts. People with established trust-based relationships will have a larger 'Open Area' quadrant than those who are unsure.

Our 'Open Area' quadrant can only be expanded if we venture into and explore our 'Blind' and 'hidden' quadrants and become more aware of them. In life, we don't know what we don't know, and when we start to become more aware of those parts of ourselves that we were previously unaware of, we become automatically empowered to take a higher degree of responsibility for ourselves and grow where necessary.

It's important to note that not everything we make available for others to see in the 'Open Area' quadrant correlates to all that there is to see. Our 'Open Area' quadrant is simply the 'face value' that we allow other people to experience. Unfortunately, when it comes to being understood by other people, many formulate assumptions about who we are based on what they see in our 'Open Area' quadrant without getting to know what's beneath. It is from this perspective that we each stand at risk of being hypocritical, for many of us often judge other people by what we see in their 'Public' quadrant, but we judge ourselves less flippantly.

Quadrant 2. The 'Blind Spot' is the subconscious which possesses reasons why we say and do the things we say and do. When we overcome the 'Blindspot' and notice parts of ourselves we weren't aware of, we become better able to make wise decisions about how to modify our



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behaviours and attitudes towards people and seek the most appropriate support/resources that promote our ongoing personal growth.

The blind spots identified in our 'Blind Spot' can range from our technical competences (or incompetencies) to our attitudinal strengths and weaknesses. The more we become aware of the weaknesses that exist in our 'Blind Spot', the more we become empowered to grow and develop. It goes without saying that we can only improve those areas in our life that we're aware are in need of improvement.

Ignoring what we discover about ourselves in our 'Blind Spot' leads us into a state of ignorance, possible denial and can cost our growth and development progress dearly. When more significant realisations of truth are embraced from within our 'Blind' quadrant, the 'Open Area' quadrant expands, and our ability to conduct ourselves transparently and authentically comes more naturally to us. It's difficult for people to like or accept us when they aren't fully aware of who we are, therefore it is essential for us to become aware of what resides in our blind quadrant so that we are more accessible and relatable to others.

From a psychological perspective, there are going to be aspects of your client's life that they're not unaware of. They will have ambitions or obstacles in life they struggle to achieve or overcome, the answers to which lie in their 'blind spots'. Practitioners offer their clients an additional and alternative perspective they cannot access by themselves, and we are the ones who ask the challenging and meaningful questions which force them to acknowledge their 'blind spots'.

Quadrant 3. The 'Facade' quadrant within our Johari window is where we keep all of the intricate details about ourselves that we don't want other people to gain access to. Examples of this could be secrets from our past, impure motives, selfish impulses or bad habits that we're ashamed of, or the role we played in a past relationship.

Sometimes what lurks in our 'Facade' quadrant isn't just hidden, but has in fact been unintentionally long forgotten. The 'Facade' quadrant represents the subconscious part of the mind where we might not always immediately remember segments of our past; however, they're not lost entirely to our memories. The 'Facade' quadrant is always known to ourselves, but not to those others in our lives. Once we remember something from our 'private' quadrant, we can re-evaluate and take ownership of it if necessary.

The reasons we keep some of our intimate personal details hidden can range from being ashamed of ourselves to pride, arrogance, self-preservation, or low trust within a relationship to do so in confidence. In either of these situations, exposing details of ourselves that would typically reside in this 'Facade' quadrant could have a broad range of positive or negative Consequences. We don't need to make all parts of ourselves available to everyone all of the time, but some of this can be crucial for a practitioner to know in order to help their client have a breakthrough. If a practitioner shows they are consistent and committed to their client, a trust will be built.

Quadrant 4. The 'Unknown' quadrant is where our highest potential for change and transformation resides. Human beings are complicated creatures; much more lies under the surface that neither ourselves or others might ever become aware of. As we go through life, the events we experience can cause the development of, what become later in life, automatic feelings, thoughts, or insights.



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These automatic feelings, thoughts, and insights make up the 'Unknown' quadrant. They constitute the profound and intricate parts of what makes us tick. After a lot of deep, self-reflection, the Unknown can become known to a client, and as these insights emerge, encourage your clients to draw them into their Johari Window and reflect on their potential significance.

AWARE OF

UNAWARE OF

PUBLIC

BLIND SPOT

**SEEN
BY YOU**

PRIVATE

THE UNKNOWN

**NOT SEEN
BY YOU**

